

**National Space Test and Training Complex (NSTTC)
Innovative Technology & Engineering - Space Test and
Range (NITE-STAR)**

Capability Development

**Multiple Award (MA) Indefinite Delivery Indefinite
Quantity (IDIQ)**

FA2553-25-R-B002



**SECTION L – INSTRUCTIONS,
CONDITIONS AND NOTICES TO
OFFERORS**

17 July 2025

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1. OVERVIEW

This acquisition for the National Space Test and Training Complex (NSTTC) Innovative Technology & Engineering - Space Test and Range (NITE-STAR) Capability Development Indefinite Delivery Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) Basic Contract will be conducted pursuant to the source selection procedures in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 15.101-2 and 15.3 as supplemented by the DoD Source Selection Procedures referenced in Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) 215.300. The Operational Test and Training Infrastructure (OTTI) Enterprise has established a Source Selection Team (SST) to evaluate the proposals submitted for this acquisition. The North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code for this effort is 541715, with a size standard of 1,000 employees.

1.1 Contract Type

The Government contemplates awarding multiple-award IDIQ contracts as a result of this solicitation. Competitions for task/delivery orders will be conducted via Fair Opportunity Request for Offer (FORFO) unless an Exception to Fair Opportunity (EFO) applies. The Government plans to utilize Firm-Fixed Price (FFP), Fixed Price Incentive Firm (FPIF), Cost Plus Incentive Fee (CPIF), Cost Plus Fixed-Fee (CPFF), Cost Reimbursable (CR), Cost Plus Award Fee (CPAF), and Fixed Price Award Fee (FPAF) contract types on the task/delivery orders, but reserves the right to use any contract type described in FAR Part 16.

1.2 Period of Performance

The ordering period for this contract will be a base five-year ordering period with one five-year option ordering period. The overall period of performance for task/delivery orders can extend beyond the ordering period but performance shall not extend more than one (1) year beyond the optional ordering period end date.

1.3 Contract Award

The Government plans to award a basic IDIQ contract to all qualifying Offerors determined to be capable of meeting the NITE-STAR Capability Development requirements. However, the Government reserves the right to make no award at all.

1.4 Point of Contact

The Procuring Contracting Officer (PCO), Ms. Crystal Price, and the Contract Specialist(s) are the sole points of contact for this IDIQ. Questions may be sent via email to the Contacting Team at SSC.TIK.NITESTAR@spaceforce.mil.

Oral communications are not permissible. No telephonic communications will be permitted.

1.5 Exchange of Information

The PCO and the Contract Specialist(s) will control electronic exchanges of source selection information between the Government and Offerors. In addition, for proper security marking, email communication shall include “Source Selection Information – See FAR 2.101 & 3.104” in the subject line. Alternate means of communication may occur if approved by the PCO.

1.6 Proposal Property

Proposals become the property of the U.S. Government after submission. The Offeror is responsible for marking its proposal pages and sections that it deems to be “proprietary”, copyrighted, or otherwise restricted from use or release.

1.7 Amendments to Solicitation

If this solicitation is amended, all terms and conditions which are not amended will remain unchanged and in full force and effect.

1.8 Consideration of Alternate Proposal

Proposals that do not address all requirements described within this document or that do not meet program objectives shall be deemed alternate proposals. Alternate proposals shall not be considered.

1.9 Debriefings

Debriefings will be handled in accordance with FAR 15.505 and FAR 15.506.

2. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

2.1 Proposal Due Date

All Offeror proposals must be submitted no later than 12:00 pm Mountain Time (MT) on **DAY MONTH 2025**. The entire proposal package must be submitted via email to SSC.TIK.NITESTAR@spaceforce.mil. Early submission is acceptable and encouraged.

2.2 Questions

Offerors may submit questions regarding the solicitation on or before 10 calendar days after release of the RFP (1700 MT, DAY MONTH 2025). The Government will provide responses to questions to all Offerors, regardless of the source of the question.

Questions shall be sent via email to the Contacting Team at SSC.TIK.NITESTAR@spaceforce.mil.

2.3 Discrepancies, Errors, and Omissions

If an Offeror believes that the requirements in these instructions contain an error, omission, or are otherwise unsound, the Offeror shall notify the Contracting Team via email within seven calendar days after Request for Proposal (RFP) and/or solicitation amendment release. The Offeror shall provide supporting rationale as well as the remedies the Offeror is asking the PCO to consider as related to the omission or error.

2.4 Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE)

Proposals shall be submitted via the Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE) Solicitation Module. The Offeror must establish a "Proposal Manager Account" in sufficient time to access documents and submit the proposal. For instructions on how to post a proposal, please refer to the Posting Offer demonstration: https://piectraining.eb.mil/wbt/sol/Posting_Offer.pdf.

The Solicitation Module is a vendor portal for solicitation within the PIEE platform to automate and secure the process for capturing solicitations, attachments, and responses from industry. The Solicitation Module allows vendors to retrieve and respond to solicitations and communicate directly with solicitation managers in a secure environment. Vendors submitting an offer in the Solicitation Module must register in PIEE and submit a request for the Proposal Manager role.

Training resources are provided below.

Vendor Registration:

<https://piectraining.eb.mil/wbt/xhtml/wbt/portal/overview/vendorRegister.xhtml>

PIEE Solicitation Web-Based Training:

<https://piectraining.eb.mil/wbt/xhtml/wbt/sol/solicitation/proposals.xhtml>

2.5 Electronic Proposal

The Offeror shall submit each volume in electronic format, unclassified only. Classified proposal information will not be accepted in response to this solicitation. Offerors will utilize PIEE and will not rely on any other electronic transmission (including transmission by email). Proposals sent

through proprietary or third-party File Transfer Protocol (FTP) sites or DoD SAFE will not be retrieved. No hard copies of proposals will be accepted (hand delivered or traditional mail).

The proposal volumes should be submitted in Adobe Acrobat portable document file (pdf) searchable text format. The Offeror shall not embed sound or video files into the proposal files. Electronic files shall be clearly identified for each volume. Offerors shall submit separate documents for each proposal volume. Each volume must be organized to be consistent with each section as identified in Table 1 - Proposal Organization. The Offeror shall use the following nomenclature for their proposal submissions: Offeror Name_FA2553-25-R-B002_Volume #.

2.6 PEE Submission

In the PEE Solicitation Module, Offerors are strongly encouraged to plan accordingly, submit proposals well in advance of the designated submission deadline, and ensure affirmative receipt of proposals. It is the Offeror's responsibility to be fully knowledgeable and capable regarding PEE. The Government will not assist Offerors in transmitting proposals within PEE. It is the Offeror's responsibility to plan far ahead of the proposal submission deadline, anticipating potential PEE connectivity delays.

After successfully submitting a proposal, a success message of the submission will be displayed in the Solicitation Module and the offer display will collapse. The "message of submission," a red lined box, will be your confirmation and should state:

"The offer was submitted on [date] [time] by Proposal Manager. Please print this page and maintain for your records."

It is the Offeror's responsibility to retain a copy of this confirmation. The Solicitation Module automatically tracks the date and time of all submissions. All proposals received after the exact time specified for receipt shall be treated as late submissions and will not be accepted by the Government, subject to the provisions of FAR 15.208.

3. PROPOSAL ORGANIZATION AND CONTENT

The Offeror's proposal must include all data and information requested in Section L and must be submitted in accordance with these instructions. Non-conformance may result in an offer being ineligible for award. The proposal materials shall be organized in four major segments: (1) Volume I – Executive Summary, (2) Volume II – Technical Factor, (3) Volume III – Small Business Participation Commitment Factor, and (4) Volume IV – Contract Documentation.

3.1 Page Limitations

The entries in the Page Limit column in Table 1 are the maximum number of pages for each volume. The Government will count each page, except for those identified in Table 1 as not being

included in the volume page count. If an Offeror's proposal exceeds the maximum pages allotted, the Government will not read, nor consider as part of the evaluation of the proposal, any pages in excess of the maximum.

For those proposal elements that have no page limits, the Offeror's response shall convey the required information in a clear and concise manner.

Offerors shall not embed additional files or other attachments within the pdf documents.

3.2 Page Size and Format

For all volumes of the proposal, Offerors shall use 8.5-inch by 11-inch pages for text sections. Offerors shall use at least 1-inch margins all around (top, bottom, left and right margins) and Times New Roman font no less than 11-point size. For charts, graphs, figures, tables, diagrams, and schematics, the text size shall be no less than 8-point Times New Roman font.

Offerors shall use no less than single line spacing for text, with no less than 6-points additional spacing between paragraphs. Bullets or tables do not require 6-points additional spacing between individual lines. Offerors shall number pages sequentially within each volume.

If the Government issues Evaluation Notices (ENs) to Offerors, all page count, page size, and format restrictions applicable to the initial proposal will also apply to EN responses and any associated changed pages, unless specifically addressed by the PCO in any instructions included in the letter of transmittal issuing the ENs to the Offeror.

3.3 Labeling

Offerors shall apply all appropriate markings, including those prescribed IAW FAR 52.215-1(e), Restriction on Disclosure and Use of Data, and FAR 3.104-4, Disclosure, Protection, and Marking of Contractor Bid or Proposal Information and Source Selection Information.

3.4 Cover Page

The Offeror shall include a cover page with each volume. The cover page shall include the Offeror's name, volume number, and solicitation number. The Offeror shall not use colors associated with security classifications. Cover pages do not count against the page limitations for their respective volumes.

3.5 Table of Contents

The Offeror shall provide a detailed table of contents for each volume (except Executive Summary) that delineates subparagraphs within that volume. The Offeror should use available navigation

tools, such as Bookmarks, in Adobe Acrobat to facilitate navigation within documents. Tables of contents do not count against the page limitations for their respective volumes.

3.6 Glossary of Abbreviations and Acronyms

The Offeror shall provide a glossary in each volume of all abbreviations and acronyms used in the volume, with an explanation or definition for each acronym or abbreviation. Glossaries do not count against the page limitations for their respective volumes.

3.7 Proposal Organization Table

Volume	Section L Paragraph	Volume Title	Page Limit
I	4	Volume I – Executive Summary - Cover Page* - Narrative Summary Overview - Glossary of Abbreviations and Acronyms*	5
II	5	Volume II – Technical Factor - Cover Page* - Table of Contents* - Technical Factor - Subfactor 1 (Gate 1): Security Compliance Requirements* - Subfactor 2: Qualifying Relevant Projects (QRPs) - Glossary of Abbreviations and Acronyms*	15
III	6	Volume III – Small Business Participation Commitment Factor - Cover Page - Table of Contents - Small Business Participation Commitment Document - Glossary of Abbreviations and Acronyms	No Limit
IV	7	Volume IV – Contract Documentation - Cover Page - Table of Contents - Company Cover Letter - Non-Government Advisors Consent/Objection - Standard Form 33 Solicitation, Offer, and Award - OCI Analysis	No Limit

		- OCI Mitigation Plan (if applicable) - CRWL Documentation (if applicable) - Small Business Plan (if applicable) - Contractor Responsibility Documentation - Glossary of Abbreviations and Acronyms	
*Not included in page limit			

Table 1 - Proposal Organization

4. INSTRUCTIONS FOR VOLUME I – EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

An Executive Summary is required from all Offerors. In this volume, the Offeror shall provide a narrative summary overview of its proposal. The Government will not evaluate this volume. The Government will not consider any of the material presented in this volume as meeting the requirements for any portions of other volumes of the proposal. If the Offeror intends information included in the narrative summary to be included in the Government's evaluation, the Offeror must provide the information in the appropriate proposal volume.

5. INSTRUCTIONS FOR VOLUME II – TECHNICAL FACTOR

5.1 General

The Technical Volume shall be clear, concise, and include all the required information in sufficient detail for effective evaluation. The Offeror should not simply rephrase or restate the Government's requirements, but rather shall provide convincing rationale to address how the Offeror intends to meet these requirements. Offerors shall assume the Government has no prior knowledge of their capabilities, work processes, facilities, or experience and will base its evaluation on the information presented in the Offeror's technical proposal.

The Technical Volume shall be organized in accordance with Table 1 - Volume Organization.

The Government will evaluate the Offeror's technical proposal as outlined in Section M, Evaluation Criteria, utilizing a gated evaluation approach for the following technical subfactors:

- Subfactor 1 (Gate 1): Security Compliance Requirements
- Subfactor 2: Qualifying Relevant Projects

5.2 Technical Subfactors

The Offeror shall submit a written technical proposal that addresses each of the following subfactors.

5.2.1 Subfactor 1 (Gate 1): Security Compliance Requirements

The Offeror shall provide evidence of a minimum facility clearance level (FCL) of TOP SECRET with Special Access Program-Facility (SAP-F) overlay that has been accredited for performing and safeguarding work up to Top Secret/Sensitive Compartmented Information (TS/SCI) and Special Access Program (SAR/SAP) as of the proposal submission date. Evidence shall be submitted in the form of an FCL letter. The FCL letter will not count against the Volume II 15-page limit.

The Offeror shall provide evidence of the ability to perform cyber security and risk management framework (RMF) type of work IAW National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-37 and NIST SP 800-53 regulations. Evidence shall be submitted in the form of NIST SP 800-37 and NIST SP 800-53 certification documents. The NIST certification documents will not count against the Volume II 15-page limit.

5.2.2 Subfactor 2: Qualifying Relevant Projects (QRPs)

The Offeror shall submit evidence of two (2) recent and relevant QRPs detailing work experience, as the prime contractor for the United States Government, within the past five (5) years. Additional QRPs submitted above the two (2) QRPs required will not be evaluated.

- The Offeror must submit one QRP focused on work experience on a project for a Low-Earth Orbit (LEO) space system (vehicle and payload), and must include, at a minimum, system development, integration, testing, launch support, and on-orbit system checkout.
- The Offeror must submit one QRP focused on work experience on a project for a Geosynchronous/Geostationary Orbit (GEO) space system (vehicle, payload, and ground system), and must include, at a minimum, system development, integration, testing, launch support, and on-orbit system checkout.

Each QRP must include the Government contract number for the work experience demonstrated in the QRP. Only one Government contract number may be submitted per QRP. Each QRP shall be a minimum of one page in length. The format for the QRP evidence shall be at the Offeror's discretion. All QRP evidence will count against the Volume II 15-page limit.

6. INSTRUCTIONS FOR VOLUME III – SMALL BUSINESS PARTICIPATION COMMITMENT FACTOR

6.1 General Instructions

The Small Business Participation Commitment Document is required from all Offerors, including small businesses and companies with Master, Individual, commercial subcontracting plans, and/or comprehensive subcontracting plans. The Offeror shall include only the first tier of subcontractors for this effort. Offerors are advised that the Small Business Participation Commitment Document is not the same as the Small Business Subcontracting Plan required by FAR 52.219-9 Alt II. Large business Offerors shall not utilize the Small Business Subcontracting Plan in the place of the Small Business Participation Commitment Document.

The Small Business Participation Commitment Document will be added to the contract as an attachment.

6.2 Small Business Participation Commitment Document

The submission shall include the following information:

- The names of subcontractors and their products and services.
- Type and complexity of the products and services to be provided by small businesses.
- The extent to which small businesses will be used relative to total contract value (notional).
- A narrative description of the Offeror's commitment to small business utilization in performance of the total available ceiling of the IDIQ. Identify the type of work (as it relates to the Statement of Work) that is planned for small business participation including a description of products and services to be provided by small businesses.

7 INSTRUCTIONS FOR VOLUME IV – CONTRACT DOCUMENTATION

7.1 General Instructions

The Offeror shall submit the following elements to support preparing the contract documents and supporting file. The Government will not evaluate contract documentation as part of the factors in Section M; however, the PCO will review the contract documentation for compliance and completeness. Errors or omissions in preparing the contract documentation could result in the PCO determining the offer to be ineligible for award.

7.2 Company Cover Letter

The Offeror shall provide a concise Cover Letter signed by an authorized agent of the company. This Cover Letter shall include the following:

- Authorized Personnel

The Offeror shall provide the name, title, telephone number, and email address of the company/division point of contact regarding the Offeror's proposal and who is authorized to obligate for their company contractually. The Offeror shall identify all individuals authorized to conduct exchanges with the Government.

- Company/Division Address, Identifying Codes, Small Business (SB) classification and Applicable Designations

The Offeror shall provide the company/division's street address, county, state and facility code; Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) code and Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) number; SB classification under North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) 541715, Research and Development in the Physical, Engineering, and Life Sciences (except Nanotechnology and Biotechnology), with a size standard of 1,000 employees.

- Government Offices

If applicable, the Offeror shall provide the mailing address, email address, telephone number, and facility codes for the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA) Contract Administration Office, Defense Contract Audit Agency (DCAA), and Government Paying Office.

- Proposal Validity

The Offeror shall make a clear statement that the proposal is valid for 240 calendar days from the proposal due date.

- Amendment Acknowledgement

If this solicitation is amended, Offerors shall acknowledge receipt of any amendments and provide confirmations.

7.3 Non-Government Advisors Consent/Objection

The PCO must ensure that before a Non-Government Advisor is given access to propriety information, that the Government has received the consent of Offerors to provide access to the contractor(s) who are assisting the Government in the source selection. The individuals participating in the review and analysis of proposals have signed nondisclosure agreements with

the Government, which strictly prohibit any release or disclosure of information outside of the source selection team.

Written consent for the Government to release data submitted in response to this solicitation to the individuals who work for the companies listed in Table 2: Non-Government Advisors shall be provided.

The Offeror shall submit written notification if it objects to the release of its proposal information to the Non-Government Advisors. Any objection to disclosure shall include a detailed statement of the basis for the objection. The detailed statement shall identify the specific portions of the proposal (to include page numbers) the Offeror objects to disclosure to Non-Government Advisors.

Explicitly indicating if consent is granted to Non-Government Advisors is mandatory and failure to address consent may result in an offer being ineligible for award.

Non-Government Advisors
The Aerospace Corporation
Galapagos Federal Systems, LLC
Science Applications International Corporation (SAIC), Inc.

Table 2: Non-Government Advisors

7.4 Standard Form 33 Solicitation, Offer, and Award

The Offeror shall:

- Complete blocks 14 (if applicable), 15, 16, 17, and 30 on the Standard Form 33 – Solicitation, Offer, and Award. The signature by the Offeror on the Standard Form 33 constitutes an offer, which the Government may or may not accept.
- Complete the fills-in found in Section I.
- Review and fill-in requested information within Section K. Provided Reps & Certs will be incorporated by reference into the contract via FAR 52.204-19.

7.5 Organizational Conflict of Interest

The Offeror shall perform an Organizational Conflict of Interest (OCI) analysis and submit the results of that analysis as part of the proposal. Specifically, the Offeror shall analyze the planned acquisition for actual or potential OCI situations associated with the Offeror or any of the Offeror's proposed teammate's or subcontractor's performance under any contract the Offeror or the Offeror's teammates or subcontractors has been or may be awarded by any federal agency or other entity. The Offeror shall describe in detail the methodology used to identify actual or potential OCI issues.

If the Offeror identifies any actual or potential OCIs with respect to the performance of the Offeror or the Offeror's subcontractors or teammates, the contractor shall provide an OCI Mitigation Plan to be incorporated as an attachment to any resulting contract. At a minimum, the plan shall address all of the items identified in the attached OCI Mitigation Plan Checklist provided as Attachment 8 to this RFP. Any proposed avoidance or mitigation techniques shall be consistent with FAR 9.5 and the most recent decisions of the Government Accountability Office (GAO) and the U.S. Court of Federal Claims.

Any Offeror who currently provides Advisory & Assistance Services (A&AS), Systems Engineering and Technical Assistance (SETA), or Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDC) support services to OTTI is precluded from submitting a proposal for this effort. Proposals from conflicted companies will be discarded without evaluation. This includes any LLC's, subsidiaries, partnerships, or any affiliations that could create the appearance of an OCI.

7.6 Space Contractor Responsibility Watch List (CRWL) (if applicable)

In accordance with 10 U.S.C. § 2271a and DAFGM 2025-63-01, Space Contractor Responsibility Watch List (CRWL), the Contracting Officer may not enter into discussions (or equivalent) with or award a contract to a contractor included on the CRWL without obtaining the approval of the Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Space Acquisition and Integration (SAF/SQ). A contractor that has been notified that it has been added to the CRWL may respond to this solicitation but must submit documentation in this volume describing the conditions that resulted in its inclusion on the CRWL and why those conditions will not impact performance on a contract resulting from this solicitation. SAF/SQ will consider information provided by the contractor as well as other available information in determining whether to authorize the Contracting Officer to enter into discussions (or equivalent) with or make an award to a contractor listed on the Space CRWL.

In addition, in accordance with 10 U.S.C. § 2271a and DAFGM 2025-63-01, Space CRWL, and the SAF/SQ Class Deviation of FAR clause 52.244-2, Subcontracts, in this solicitation, the offeror must receive written consent of the Contracting Officer prior to subcontracting with any contractor on the CRWL for any subcontract, regardless of dollar value. The Contracting Officer may not provide this consent without obtaining the approval of SAF/SQ. Offerors must require proposed subcontractors to notify the offeror if the subcontractor has been notified by SAF/SQ that they have been included on the CRWL. In order to be considered for a subcontract, a proposed subcontractor that is on the CRWL must submit documentation describing the conditions that resulted in its inclusion on the CRWL and why those conditions will not impact subcontract performance. The proposed subcontractor may submit CRWL-related documentation through the offeror or directly to the Contracting Officer as long as the information is received prior to the proposal due date. In addition, the offeror must submit its determination of subcontractor responsibility in this volume. SAF/SQ will consider information provided by the prime contractor and the proposed subcontractor as well as other available information in determining whether to authorize the Contracting Officer to grant consent to subcontract.

7.7 Small Business Subcontracting Plan (if applicable)

Offerors, other than Small Business Offerors, must submit a Small Business Subcontracting Plan meeting the requirements of FAR 52.219-9 Alt II and DFARS 252.219-7003 (or DFARS 252.219-7004 if the Offeror has a comprehensive subcontracting plan). The plan, at a minimum shall address the elements set forth in FAR 52-219-9(d)(1) through (11).

Subcontracting plans will only be reviewed for acceptability for the Offeror(s) deemed to be an apparent awardee. If the apparent awardee's Small Business Subcontracting Plan is not initially acceptable, the PCO may request additional information or clarification regarding the Small Business Subcontracting Plan.

7.8 Contractor Responsibility

The Offeror shall provide information that presents a brief verifiable self-assessment in the areas of responsibility as described in FAR 9.104 as supplemented by DFARS and Department of the Air Force Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DAFFARS). Elements of responsibility to address include but are not limited to, management of government property, capability, resources, competency, capacity, credit, integrity, perseverance, tenacity, and limitations on subcontracting.

In the event the PCO is unable to determine the Offeror's responsibility, procedures at FAR Part 19.6 will be used.